Console on the Move

How to drive the Console app on an Ableton Move: an 8-track tape with OP-1-style editing, up to 8 instruments (drum machines and synths) and a step sequencer. This covers the controls as they are in November 2026. Things still to come are listed at the end.

Starting and stopping

Start Console	Shift + Step 2 (the Move's settings), then choose **RNBO** at the bottom of the list. Console opens by itself after a few seconds. The menu item keeps the name RNBO.
Quit	**Shift + Back**. Saves the song, quits and gives the Move back to its normal software.
If something goes wrong	If the app ever crashes, the Move goes back to normal by itself. What it printed is saved in /data/UserData/console/app.log.
Update	From the Mac: `ssh ableton@move.local "python3 /data/UserData/console/move/move-update.py"`. Quit Console first.

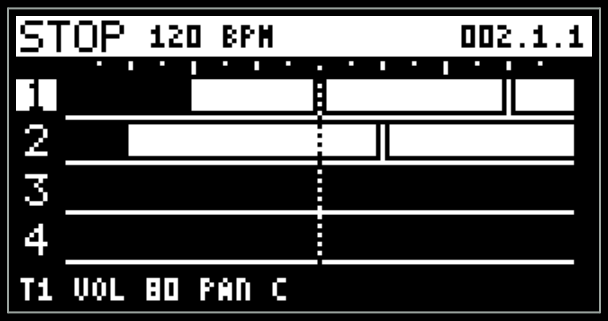
The Move's controls at a glance

Most buttons have a second job with **Shift** held. Each page below says what changes there.

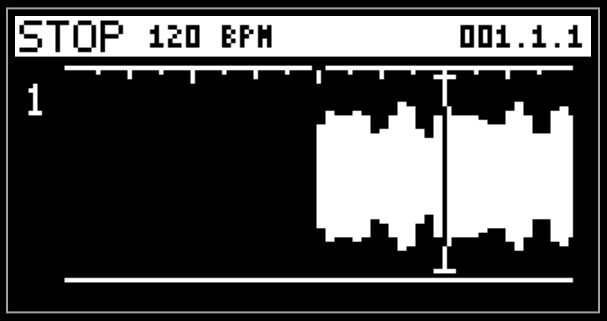
Play	Play / stop. Shift: back to the start (or the loop's start).
Record	Record on the selected track (and any armed tracks). Shift: switch between replacing the tape and adding to it (overdub).
Loop	Loop between the in and out points on / off. Shift: clear the in and out points.
Left / Right arrows	Move the playhead one grid step. Shift: set the loop's in / out point at the playhead.
Undo	Undo the last tape edit (on the drum sequencer: the last pattern edit).
Sample	Splice: split the box under the playhead (at a splice: join it back). Shift: on every track.
Copy (hold)	Copy the box under the playhead. Hold and turn the jog wheel to take more pieces, let go to copy. Shift + Copy: start a selection.
Delete (hold)	Cut, the same way as Copy (it leaves an empty space).
Capture	Drop (paste) what was copied or cut at the playhead. Shift: insert it, pushing the rest of the track later.
Mute	Mute the selected track. Shift: solo it.
Menu	The project menu (songs, tempo, settings). On the drum page: the kit menu. **Shift + Menu: export.**
Back	Back out of a menu or page. **Shift + Back: save and quit.**

Left buttons (top to bottom)	1 Tape. 2 Instruments (press again: the instrument's sound, again: its sequencer; Shift: back). 3 FX (reverb, then delay, then off). 4 The selected track zoomed (Shift: arm all tracks).
Knobs 1-8	Depend on the page (below). On the tape: the 8 tracks' volumes; Shift: pan.
Shift + touch a knob	Pushes that knob (the Pi's knob push): on the tape it mutes that track.
+ / -	The Pi's knob 9: on the tape, zoom in / out. Shift: sweep the in / out points a bar at a time.
Jog wheel	Turn: move the playhead a grid step. Shift + turn: the grid size. Push: back to the start. In lists and menus: turn to pick, push to choose.
Volume knob	Headphone / speaker volume.
Step buttons	On the tape: 1-8 select a track (press the selected one again to zoom in); Shift + step: arm a track. On the drum sequencer: the 16 steps.
Pads	Play the instrument you're on (a drum a pad, bottom row first; a synth plays a scale). On the drum sequencer they pick the drum.

The tape



The tape page: four tracks at a time (the selected track's group) as solid boxes; a splice is a thin divider. The dotted line is the playhead. Bottom: volume and pan.



Left button 4: the selected track zoomed, its sound as a waveform; a splice is an I-beam. The notch in the ruler is the playhead.

Step buttons 1-8	Select a track. The screen shows tracks 1-4 or 5-8, whichever group it's in.
Shift + step 1-8	Arm or disarm a track: armed tracks record too, and Copy / Delete / Sample take them along. A dot beside the number marks it.
Knobs 1-8	Track volumes. Shift + knob: pan.
Record	Start / stop recording on the selected track and any armed tracks.
Splices	A splice shows as a thin divider between two boxes (zoomed in: an I-beam through the sound).

The zoomed track (left button 4)

Knob 1	Mono / stereo.
Knob 2	The input: an instrument's drum, its kit, all kits (and on a stereo track, its left side).
Knob 3	A stereo track's right input.
Knobs 4-6	The box under the playhead: gain, fade in, fade out. Shift + touch knob 4: normalize.
Left button 4 / Back	Back to the tape.

Instruments

Left button 2 opens the INSTRUMENTS page: 8 slots, each a drum machine or a synth. Recording an instrument onto the tape uses the zoomed track's input (knob 2).

Jog wheel	Pick a slot. Push: open it (an empty slot: choose what goes in it).
Shift + push the jog wheel	On a loaded slot: change it or remove it.
Step buttons 1-8	Mute / unmute a slot.
Left button 2 again	The picked instrument's sound page; again: its sequencer.

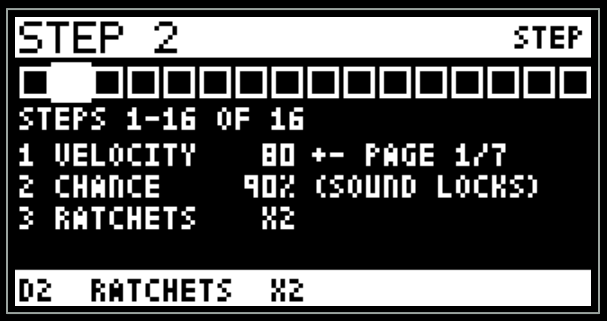
An instrument's sound

Knobs 1-8	The settings on this page. While one turns, it shows big.
+ / -	The next / previous page of settings.
Shift + touch a knob	That setting back to its starting value.
Pads	Play the drums (or the synth).
Menu	The kit menu (load / save kits).

The drum sequencer

The steps live on the 16 step buttons, the screen shows what the knobs do. Each drum (lane) has its own length, up to 64 steps, and its own speed.

No step held: the drum's 16 steps (small, at the top) and the lane's settings.



A step held: that step's velocity, chance and ratchets.

Pads	Pick the drum (its pad lights brighter) and hear it.
Step buttons	Press and let go: the step on / off. While playing, the playhead moves along them.
Left / Right arrows	Steps 17-32, 33-48, 49-64 (for lanes longer than 16).
Knob 1	LENGTH: the lane's number of steps (1-64).
Knob 2	RATE: the lane's speed (1/16, 1/16 triplets, 1/8, 1/8 triplets, 1/32).
Knob 3	EUCLID: spread a number of hits evenly over the lane (OFF to switch it off).
Knob 4	SHIFT: turn the lane's pattern around by steps.
+ / -	The pattern (1-16). While playing, the next one waits its turn (shown as PAT 1>2).
Undo	Undo the last pattern edit.

Holding a step

A step held, + pressed: the drum's sound page. Turning a knob locks that setting to this step (shown highlighted).

Knob 1	VELOCITY of the step.
Knob 2	CHANCE: how often it plays (100% down to 0%, or 1:2, 2:3... = the 1st of every 2 times round, and so on).
Knob 3	RATCHETS: the step plays 1-4 times.
+ / - (still holding)	Go through the drum's sound pages. Their knobs then set the sound for this step only (a parameter lock).
Let go	If you turned a knob, the step stays as it was (on or off). If you didn't, it's an ordinary press: on / off.
Another step while holding	Switches that step on / off.

Synths: the synth sequencer screen isn't done yet on the Move (its pads play the synth).

FX

Left button 3	Reverb page, again: delay page, again: back.
Knobs 1-8	How much of each track goes to the effect (its send).
+ / -	Reverb size / delay time.
Shift + turn the jog wheel	Reverb tone / delay feedback.
Jog wheel	The effect's level.

The screen labels these settings 1, 2, 3; they're on + / -, Shift + wheel and the wheel.

Menus and export

Menu	The project menu: songs (new, open, save as), tempo, time signature, export format, settings. Jog wheel: pick, push: choose, Back: close.
Shift + Menu	Export: a stereo mix and one file per track, in /data/UserData/console/data/exports/(song name and time)/.

To copy the exports to the Mac's desktop:

```
scp -r "ableton@move.local:/data/UserData/console/data/exports" ~/Desktop/move-exports
```

Not on the Move yet

The synth sequencer screen and its step buttons; bounce (recording several tracks onto one); the tape's bar/beat grid when zoomed in a long way. Songs are saved in /data/UserData/console/data.